

LEADERSHIP ALIGNMENT INSTRUMENT

Mission Product Automation Leadership Assessment

Clarifies mission priorities, intended outcomes, non-negotiable guardrails, and the evidence leadership will accept as success.

AUDIENCE	COMPLETION	PRIMARY OUTPUT
Commander / director, deputies, mission owners	30-45 minutes	Ranked priorities + success definition

Security and OPSEC: Complete this instrument only at the classification level of the system being used. Use category-level descriptions here; move operational details, sources, vulnerabilities, and sensitive examples to an approved environment.

Assessment posture: This is not a technology wish list or a maturity score. It establishes what is actually happening, what outcomes matter, where human accountability must remain, and what evidence should govern pilot decisions.

Respondent information

Unit / organization [Enter]	Name and role [Enter]
Date [Enter]	Interviewed by [Enter]

A Which mission area, staff function, or operational problem is in scope for this engagement?

[Type response here]

1. Mission Context and Decision Environment

Begin with mission reality. Do not assume the product itself is the end goal.

1.1 What mission outcome(s) do these products support? What becomes possible when the products are timely and trusted?

[Type response here]

1.2 Who consumes the products, and what decisions or actions do they enable?

[Type response here]

1.3 What is the operational tempo: routine cycle, surge conditions, short-notice tasking, and peak demand?

[Type response here]

1.4 What are the consequences of a late, incomplete, inconsistent, or incorrect product?

[Type response here]

1.5 What should never be optimized away in pursuit of speed (for example: commander intent, judgment, nuance, accountability, security, or relationship)?

[Type response here]

2. Priority Mission Products

Identify the product portfolio first; rank automation candidates only after mission value and constraints are visible.

Product / recurring deliverable	Primary consumer	Decision or action enabled	Typical frequency
[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]

Leadership priority rating

Rate each named product from 1 (low) to 5 (high). Readiness reflects the availability of authoritative inputs, repeatable rules, access, and an accountable owner.

Product	Mission impact	Current burden	Time sensitivity	Readiness	Leader priority
[Enter]	[1-5]	[1-5]	[1-5]	[1-5]	[1-5]
[Enter]	[1-5]	[1-5]	[1-5]	[1-5]	[1-5]
[Enter]	[1-5]	[1-5]	[1-5]	[1-5]	[1-5]
[Enter]	[1-5]	[1-5]	[1-5]	[1-5]	[1-5]
[Enter]	[1-5]	[1-5]	[1-5]	[1-5]	[1-5]
[Enter]	[1-5]	[1-5]	[1-5]	[1-5]	[1-5]

2.1 Which three products should be examined first, and why are they more important than the others?

[Type response here]

3. What Success Must Look Like

Define observable change, a baseline, a target, and a responsible evidence owner. Avoid promising causation or ROI before a pilot is measured.

☐ Shorter end-to-end cycle time	☐ Less hands-on production time
☐ Fewer corrections or revision rounds	☐ Higher accuracy or completeness
☐ More consistent format and content	☐ Faster response to changing conditions
☐ Greater surge capacity	☐ Better continuity across personnel turnover
☐ Stronger source traceability / auditability	☐ Reduced duplicate entry and handoffs
☐ More time for analysis and mission judgment	☐ Improved user confidence and adoption

Select no more than four primary outcomes. A successful pilot should improve these outcomes without violating the guardrails in Section 4.

Outcome	Current baseline	Target / threshold	By when	Evidence source + owner
[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]

3.1 At 90 days, what must be measurably true for leadership to continue, expand, modify, or stop the effort?

[Type response here]

3.2 If personnel regain time, where should that time be reinvested to produce mission value?

[Type response here]

3.3 What result would look impressive but would not actually count as mission success?

[Type response here]

4. Human Decision Authority and Guardrails

Set boundaries before selecting a tool. The system may assist; accountable people retain material mission decisions.

Activity	Allowed	Case-by-case	Prohibited	Approver / condition
Find or retrieve approved source material	☐	☐	☐	[Enter]
Extract, summarize, or compare content	☐	☐	☐	[Enter]
Assemble a first draft from approved inputs	☐	☐	☐	[Enter]
Suggest phrasing, structure, or visuals	☐	☐	☐	[Enter]
Check format, completeness, and consistency	☐	☐	☐	[Enter]
Reconcile conflicting sources	☐	☐	☐	[Enter]
Make or recommend an operational decision	☐	☐	☐	[Enter]
Publish, release, transmit, or brief without review	☐	☐	☐	[Enter]

4.1 Which judgments must remain distinctly human, and who is accountable for them?

[Type response here]

4.2 What failures are unacceptable even once? Which errors are tolerable only if detected before release?

[Type response here]

4.3 What source traceability, citations, confidence indicators, or review evidence must accompany generated content?

[Type response here]

4.4 Who has authority to approve the pilot, authorize production use, pause it, and retire it?

[Type response here]

5. Constraints, Readiness, and Dependencies

Surface the conditions that determine whether a useful idea can be implemented safely and adopted in practice.

☐ Classification / compartmentation	☐ Approved network or hosting environment
☐ Data access or releasability	☐ Authoritative-source availability
☐ Cybersecurity approval	☐ Records retention / discoverability
☐ Identity, role, and permission controls	☐ Integration with existing systems
☐ Procurement or licensing	☐ Staff availability for discovery and testing
☐ Template / SOP inconsistency	☐ Trust, adoption, or workforce concern
☐ Training and support capacity	☐ External policy or legal constraint

Check every constraint that could materially affect scope, schedule, data access, or acceptable design.

5.1 Which systems, repositories, templates, and data sources are approved and authoritative?

[Type response here]

5.2 What must be true before real mission data can be used in discovery, testing, or evaluation?

[Type response here]

5.3 Where is the unit ready to experiment, and where is it not ready?

[Type response here]

5.4 What other initiatives, dependencies, or competing priorities could help or hinder this work?

[Type response here]

6. Ownership, Adoption, and Operating Model

Identify the coalition that will sponsor, govern, test, and sustain the capability.

Required role	Named person / office	Authority or contribution	Availability / decision cadence
Executive sponsor	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
Mission / product owner	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
Product creators / SMEs	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
Cyber / security / data authority	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
Technical / integration owner	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
Training / change lead	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
Evaluation / evidence owner	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]

6.1 What concerns are people likely to have about quality, control, workload, roles, or workforce impact?

[Type response here]

6.2 How will leadership communicate the purpose of the effort and invite honest feedback without pressuring people to report success?

[Type response here]

6.3 Who will own the capability after the consulting engagement ends?

[Type response here]

7. Leadership Commitment and Final Priorities

Close with explicit priorities, decision criteria, and access commitments.

Rank	Product / use case	Mission outcome	Why now	Pilot decision owner
1	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
2	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
3	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]

7.1 Complete this sentence: This engagement will be successful if, by [date], the unit can _____ while preserving _____, as demonstrated by _____.

[Type response here]

7.2 What access, personnel time, sample artifacts, and decisions will leadership commit to make available?

[Type response here]

7.3 What is explicitly out of scope for this engagement?

[Type response here]

Leadership confirmation

Name / role	Decision	Signature or concurrence	Date
[Enter]	☐ Proceed ☐ Revise ☐ Hold	[Enter]	[Enter]
[Enter]	☐ Proceed ☐ Revise ☐ Hold	[Enter]	[Enter]
[Enter]	☐ Proceed ☐ Revise ☐ Hold	[Enter]	[Enter]

8. Consultant Synthesis

Complete after comparing leadership responses with workflow evidence. Record observations, interpretations, decisions, and unresolved assumptions separately.

Category	Synthesis
Direct observations / evidence	[Enter]
Patterns or tensions to investigate	[Enter]
Current interpretation (not yet fact)	[Enter]
Agreed decisions and boundaries	[Enter]
Open assumptions / evidence needed	[Enter]

Initial use-case screen

Candidate	Mission value	Feasibility	Risk / guardrail load	Evidence readiness	Recommendation
[Enter]	[L/M/H]	[L/M/H]	[L/M/H]	[L/M/H]	[Explore / Defer / Decline]
[Enter]	[L/M/H]	[L/M/H]	[L/M/H]	[L/M/H]	[Explore / Defer / Decline]
[Enter]	[L/M/H]	[L/M/H]	[L/M/H]	[L/M/H]	[Explore / Defer / Decline]
[Enter]	[L/M/H]	[L/M/H]	[L/M/H]	[L/M/H]	[Explore / Defer / Decline]
[Enter]	[L/M/H]	[L/M/H]	[L/M/H]	[L/M/H]	[Explore / Defer / Decline]

Design basis: Lead Emergence sequence (See Reality, Reframe, Align, Build Capability, Produce Value, See Again); evidence before framework matching; human authorization; measurable value hypotheses; role and workflow evidence; readiness, trust, governance, and consequence-aware AI adoption.